

SMB Credential Validation Evidence Report

Internal Network & Active Directory Pentest Evidence Documentation

Field	Details
Test Area	SMB credential validation
Evidence Source	12-smb-enumeration-credential-validation.png
Result Type	Credentials validated
Primary Tool / Component	NetExec / CrackMapExec style SMB validation
MITRE ATT&CK Mapping	T1078 - Valid Accounts; T1021.002 - SMB/Windows Admin Shares
Document Purpose	Professional GitHub-ready evidence report with redacted screenshot and interpretation.

This report documents one specific evidence row from the AD Network assessment. It is intentionally evidence-specific, not a generic attack tutorial. Sensitive values have been blurred or represented as redacted placeholders for safe portfolio publication.

1. Embedded Evidence Screenshot

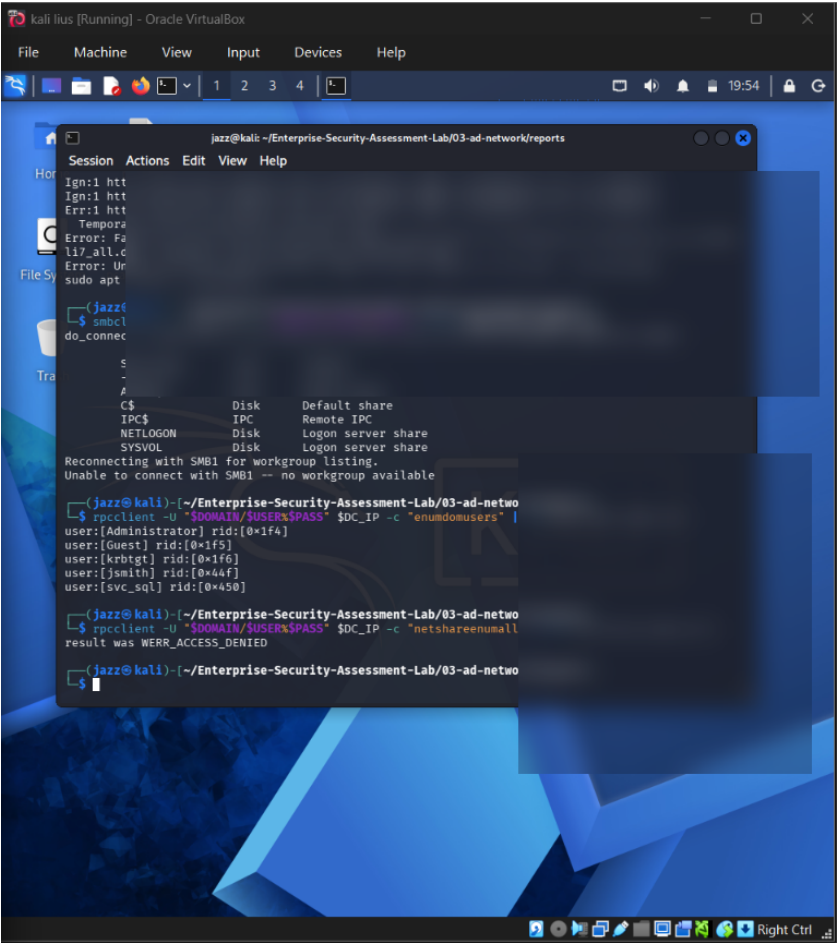


Figure 1 - Redacted evidence screenshot: 12-smb-enumeration-credential-validation.png

What this screenshot proves

The screenshot shows SMB credential validation and enumeration activity. Credentials and sensitive command content are blurred.

Evidence Context

Area	Value
Testing Phase	Credential Validation and SMB Enumeration
Tool / Component	NetExec / CrackMapExec style SMB validation
Objective	Confirm whether recovered lab credentials are valid against SMB services and determine the level of access available.
Result Type	Credentials validated

2. Evidence-Specific Methodology

This section explains how this evidence fits into the overall internal network and Active Directory attack path. The goal is to demonstrate professional testing logic, not simply show a terminal screenshot.

- Use recovered lab credentials only inside the isolated domain lab.
- Validate authentication against the domain controller or workstation SMB service.
- Enumerate shares and basic access rights.
- Record evidence while redacting password material.

Command / Workflow Used

```
netexec smb <DC_IP> -d <DOMAIN> -u <USER> -p <REDACTED_PASSWORD>  
netexec smb <DC_IP> -d <DOMAIN> -u <USER> -p <REDACTED_PASSWORD> --shares
```

Sanitized Output Style

```
SMB <DC_IP> 445 DC01 [+] CORP\<REDACTED_USER>:<REDACTED_PASSWORD>  
Shares enumerated: <REDACTED_LIST>
```

Assessment Interpretation

The evidence supports the result type: Credentials validated. In a professional assessment, this evidence would be paired with the exact testing scope, timestamps, target identifiers, and remediation ownership. For GitHub publication, the report intentionally avoids showing live secrets, passwords, hashes, or reusable credential material.

3. Risk Analysis

Valid credentials turn a captured hash event into an active foothold. Even low-privileged access can enable LDAP/SMB enumeration, BloodHound collection, Kerberoasting, and further attack-path discovery.

Why this matters in enterprise AD environments

- Active Directory attacks often chain multiple medium-risk issues into domain compromise.
- Credential material, even when not plaintext, can become dangerous if cracking, relaying, or alternate authentication is possible.
- Graph-based permissions and relationship analysis is necessary because AD risk is often hidden in group nesting and delegated rights.
- Evidence must be documented clearly so defenders can connect the technical finding to a specific control gap.

Recommended Remediation

- Monitor successful logons after suspicious name-resolution activity.
- Restrict SMB share permissions.
- Remove unnecessary local admin rights.
- Apply least privilege to domain users.
- Use Microsoft Defender for Identity or similar AD monitoring.

Detection and Monitoring Opportunities

- Correlate authentication events with unusual source hosts and off-hours activity.
- Monitor SMB, LDAP, Kerberos, and replication-related event patterns.
- Alert on abnormal use of administrative protocols and credential dumping indicators.
- Review domain privilege assignments and privileged group membership changes regularly.

4. GitHub Publication and Redaction Guidance

This report is prepared for safe GitHub portfolio publication. The embedded screenshot has been treated as evidence, but sensitive material must not be recoverable or readable.

Sensitive Item	Action for GitHub
NTLM / NetNTLMv2 hashes	Blur or remove completely. Never publish reusable hash material.
Kerberos TGS / krb5tgs values	Blur or replace with <REDACTED_TICKET>.
Plaintext passwords	Do not publish. Replace with <REDACTED_PASSWORD>.
DCSync / NTDS hashes	Treat as domain compromise material and fully redact.
Internal IPs / domain names	May remain for lab context, but redact if privacy is required.
Username / service accounts	Keep only if lab-only; otherwise redact or generalize.

Suggested GitHub Link

[Open Report](./reports/evidence/03-smb-credential-validation-evidence-report.pdf)

Professional Note

This document should be stored with the AD Network module reports, preferably under 03-ad-network/reports/evidence/. It is designed to replace a plain screenshot filename in the Evidence-Based Testing Summary table with a professional clickable report.